

ALBERTA DISABILITY BREAKDOWN

The Consultation Gap

A Five-Layer Structural Rebuttal

Examining the Government of Alberta's claim that the Alberta Disability Assistance Program was developed through extensive consultation with thousands of Albertans with disabilities — and why that claim is structurally unsustainable

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THE QUESTION THIS DOCUMENT ADDRESSES

On September 12, 2025, the Government of Alberta concluded what it characterized as extensive consultation with thousands of Albertans with disabilities on the Alberta Disability Assistance Program. Between that date and the tabling of petitions at the Alberta Legislature, Albertans with disabilities organized, circulated, signed, and delivered petitions opposing the ADAP transition in numbers the government's own consultation record cannot match.

The question this document addresses is direct: what kind of consultation produces, as its documented post-consultation outcome, mass-scale opposition from the population the consultation was about?

This document is not an attack. It does not impute motive. It does not allege bad faith. It examines the structural characteristics of the consultation process the Government of Alberta

conducted, the documented record of what occurred before and after the September 12, 2025 close date, and the question of whether what the government has called consultation can sustain that description under examination.

The examination proceeds in five layers. Each layer is drawn from primary-source documentation — the government's own published materials, legislative records, advocacy organization analyses, and contemporaneous news reporting. Each layer identifies a structural gap between the government's consultation claim and the documented record. Taken individually, each layer raises a serious question about the adequacy of the consultation. Taken together, they establish that the foundational rhetorical claim of the ADAP rollout — that the program reflects what Albertans with disabilities asked for — cannot be reconciled with the documented record of what Albertans with disabilities have said, in writing, with their names, before and after September 12, 2025.

What the Government of Alberta claims

The Government of Alberta's ADAP information page on alberta.ca states:

ADAP is being thoughtfully designed, based on input from Albertans with disabilities... ADAP public engagement concluded September 12, 2025. Thousands of Albertans participated in engagement via roundtables, telephone town halls, written submissions and the online survey. Public engagement was undertaken in addition to engagement with disability advocates and service providers, including through roundtables and meetings. — Government of Alberta, ADAP public information page (alberta.ca/alberta-disability-assistance-program)”

The engagement page further states that “Albertans with disabilities and the organizations that support them have made it clear they want supports that meet their unique needs and abilities, rather than the one-size-fits-all approach currently offered by the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program.”

Minister Jason Nixon, the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, has repeated versions of this framing publicly, including in correspondence to AISH recipients and in response to municipal motions calling for an ADAP pause. The foundational rhetorical structure of the ADAP rollout is that the program reflects the expressed preferences of the population it affects. Every government defence of the program against criticism rests on that foundation.

The remainder of this document examines whether that foundation is structurally sound.

LAYER 1 The consultation method structurally excluded the population it was about

AISH eligibility requires a severe, permanent disability that substantially limits the ability to earn a livelihood. The Government of Alberta's own eligibility criteria, as set out in the AISH Adjudication Guide and Your Guide to AISH, define a population characterized by significant cognitive, physical, mental health, and communication-based disabilities of sufficient severity that employment is not possible for the vast majority of recipients.

The documented caseload profile, per Alberta Community and Social Services open data, confirms this characterization:

- 44.1 percent of AISH recipients have a primary medical condition related to physical disability.
- 30.4 percent of AISH recipients have a primary medical condition related to mental illness disorders.
- 25.4 percent of AISH recipients have a primary medical condition related to cognitive disorders.
- 83.6 percent of AISH recipients had no employment income in 2023-24, per Inclusion Alberta analysis of government data.
- A substantial portion of the caseload resides in supportive living, group homes, long-term care, or other facility settings where independent internet access depends on staff or family support.

The consultation modalities

The Government of Alberta's stated consultation modalities, per the engagement page:

- Online survey open August 13 to September 14, 2025, requiring 20 to 25 minutes to complete.
- Telephone town halls held September 4 and September 5, 2025.
- Written submissions accepted through September 12, 2025.
- Roundtables and meetings with disability advocates and service providers.

The structural gap

The population described in the caseload data and the consultation modalities described on the engagement page are not compatible. Specifically:

- A 20-to-25 minute online survey requires sustained attention, reading comprehension, written expression, internet access, device access, data plan or WiFi availability, and the cognitive capacity to navigate a multi-screen survey interface. For a substantial share of the AISH caseload, one or more of these requirements is a barrier arising directly from the disability the benefit exists to address.

- Telephone town halls held on two specific dates, during business hours, require knowledge of the scheduled dates, access to a telephone at those times, and the ability to participate by listening and responding to complex policy questions in real time. For recipients with hearing disabilities, cognitive disabilities affecting processing speed, or anxiety disorders affecting phone engagement, this modality is structurally inaccessible.
- Written submissions require literacy levels and written-expression capacity that are not universal across the AISH caseload.
- Roundtables and meetings with advocates and service providers — the fourth modality — are, by their stated description, not consultation with recipients. They are consultation with organizations about recipients.

The Accessible Canada Act and Alberta's provincial accessibility framework both establish the principle that consultation and engagement processes affecting persons with disabilities must be designed to be accessible to those persons, with accommodations made for the specific forms of disability that characterize the affected population. A consultation process that relies on methods requiring capacities the population lacks, by definition of the eligibility criteria the government itself administers, does not meet that principle.

The Government of Alberta designed a consultation process that structurally required the capacities the AISH disability the benefit exists to address most frequently impairs. A consultation that cannot reach the population it concerns is not consultation with that population. It is consultation about them."

LAYER 2 The “thousands” were predominantly stakeholders, not recipients

The Government of Alberta's consultation page characterizes the engagement as having reached “thousands of Albertans” participating through the four modalities described above. The government has not published a breakdown of the participants by category, by program eligibility status, by Indigenous status, by facility residency, by caregiver status, or by any other demographic that would permit assessment of who those thousands actually were.

Based on the documented modalities and the population characteristics described in Layer 1, the likely composition of the “thousands” participants includes:

- Service provider organizations — group home operators, disability service agencies, supported employment providers, vocational rehabilitation providers, community-based disability support organizations.

- Professional advocacy organizations and their staff — including organizations whose work is structurally oriented toward the existing disability service system.
- Healthcare professionals and their professional bodies — physicians, nurses, occupational therapists, social workers, and the associations representing them.
- Academic researchers and graduate students working in disability policy.
- Family members and caregivers of AISH recipients — who are a legitimate stakeholder category but are not themselves recipients.
- Municipal social services staff and related government employees.
- Non-AISH disabled Albertans whose interest in the program is general rather than specific.
- Some AISH recipients — those whose disabilities did not prevent them from participating in the modalities described, and who had access to the technical requirements and scheduling windows involved.

Each of these categories has legitimate input to offer. None of them, other than the last, is the recipient population whose benefits are being changed. A consultation process that produces “thousands of responses” from that mix, and then reports the total as “thousands of Albertans with disabilities participated in shaping the program,” is performing a specific rhetorical move: substituting stakeholder input for recipient consent.

The comparison the government has not published

The Government of Alberta possesses, in its administrative systems, the data that would resolve this question conclusively. Every ADAP survey response is, presumably, associated with demographic information including whether the respondent is a current AISH recipient. The telephone town hall participation records include caller identification and self-identification as recipients or non-recipients. The written submissions include identifying information about the submitter’s category.

Publication of a breakdown of the “thousands” by category — current AISH recipients, family members, service providers, advocates, non-recipient Albertans with disabilities, and other — would either confirm the government’s rhetorical framing (if the breakdown shows a majority of respondents are current AISH recipients who affirm the program as designed) or collapse it (if the breakdown shows recipients are a minority of respondents or that recipients who did respond expressed concerns the final program does not reflect).

As of the date of this document’s publication, the Government of Alberta has not published that breakdown. The absence is itself evidence. Governments that can substantiate their consultation claims with specific participant breakdowns publish the breakdowns. Governments that characterize “thousands of Albertans with disabilities” as having shaped a program do not, absent the breakdown, have documented evidence that the thousands were the population the rhetorical claim implies.

The government has the data to resolve this question. They have not published it. The absence is the argument.”

LAYER 3 Key provisions were introduced after consultation closed

The Government of Alberta’s stated consultation period ran from approximately mid-August 2025 to September 12, 2025. The program elements that were on the table during that consultation window were those published in the ADAP Discussion Guide released in summer 2025. Elements introduced after September 12, 2025 were, by definition, not part of what the consultation’s participants could have consulted on.

Bill 12 and the removal of appeal rights

Bill 12, which received Royal Assent on December 9, 2025, included provisions that:

- Removed the right of appeal to the independent Citizens Appeal Panel for AISH and ADAP eligibility decisions.
- Established a Medical Review Panel whose decisions on AISH eligibility are final, with no recourse to an independent body.
- Removed from legislation the requirement for annual cost-of-living increases to disability benefits.
- Granted the Lieutenant Governor in Council the authority to further limit which decisions can be appealed.

These provisions were publicly tabled in legislation approximately two months after the consultation window had closed. Albertans with disabilities who opposed the removal of independent appeal rights had no consultation window in which to do so. The legislative record establishes that the most consequential structural provision of the ADAP transition — the removal of the administrative remedy by which an AISH recipient could individually challenge an eligibility decision — was not part of what the consultation’s participants could have addressed.

The employment exemption figures

The ADAP Discussion Guide released in summer 2025 described employment income exemptions that formed the basis of public consultation on the program’s employment incentive structure. Inclusion Alberta’s analysis of the Discussion Guide, published in October and December 2025, worked from the figures in the Discussion Guide to model the program’s effects on employed and underemployed recipients.

The Government of Alberta’s current ADAP information page, accessed in April 2026, states that employment income earnings above \$700 per month will gradually reduce ADAP financial

benefits, and that Albertans on ADAP will be able to earn more than \$45,000 in employment income while continuing to receive financial benefits. This figure differs materially from the figures in the Discussion Guide that were the basis of consultation feedback. The current government page notes that “detailed calculations for ADAP employment income exemptions will be set out in a Ministerial Order later this spring.”

The specific implication: the figures on which consultation feedback was solicited are not the figures the government has subsequently committed to, and the figures the government has subsequently committed to are, as of April 2026, not yet fully public pending a Ministerial Order. The consultation took place on one set of numbers. The regulations will be issued on another. Participants in the September 2025 consultation cannot have consulted on figures that did not yet exist.

The foundational implication

A consultation process exists to gather input on what a government proposes to do. When the most consequential elements of what the government proposes to do are developed and introduced after the consultation window closes, those elements have not been consulted on. The consultation did not produce input on them. The consultation’s participants did not have the opportunity to address them. Describing the resulting program as having been “shaped by” the consultation requires omitting the provisions that were not part of the consultation.

Consultation closed September 12, 2025. Bill 12 passed December 9, 2025. The most consequential structural provision of the transition — the removal of independent appeal rights — was never consulted on. The participants who fed back on the Discussion Guide were not asked about, and could not have been asked about, a provision that did not yet exist.”

LAYER 4 The petition is the documented empirical rebuttal

The strongest documentary evidence of whether a consultation process secured the consent of the population it was about is the population’s subsequent behaviour. Populations that have been meaningfully consulted, whose input has been reflected in the resulting policy, and whose consent the process secured, do not typically organize mass-scale opposition to the resulting policy after the consultation closes. When they do, the opposition is itself documentary evidence that the consultation did not produce the consent it was supposed to produce.

The petition

In September 2025 — the same month the Government of Alberta concluded its consultation — Edmonton AISH recipient Darryl Learie began organizing a petition opposing the AISH-to-ADAP transition. Mr. Learie, who has been an AISH recipient for nearly 30 years and who lives with

generalized anxiety, chronic depression, ADHD, and is on the autism spectrum, organized the petition through a combination of paper signature collection and online outreach, with paper signatures collected through community partners in multiple Alberta municipalities including Red Deer volunteers gathering signatures at City Hall and at community businesses.

The petition calls on the provincial government to:

- Halt the proposed transition of AISH recipients into the Alberta Disability Assistance Program.
- Cancel the proposed ADAP program.
- Maintain existing AISH supports, including benefit levels and earning exemptions.
- Ensure that all applicants for disability assistance have access to a fair appeals process.

The tabling at the Legislature

On April 14 or 15, 2026, during the Spring Session of the Alberta Legislature, the Opposition NDP tabled Mr. Learie's paper petition during question period, with 5,674 signatures on the paper version officially received by the Legislature. The online version of the petition, which is not officially received by the Legislature as it does not meet provincial petition requirements, contained additional signatures at the time of tabling. Mr. Learie personally attended the Legislature for the tabling and spoke to media about his reasons for organizing the petition.

Mr. Learie's public statement, per CBC News coverage of April 16, 2026:

Programs like AISH are designed to remove the pressure of working so that people can focus on managing serious mental health conditions. When too much pressure is being put on me, I tend to destabilize and fall apart. — Darryl Learie, AISH recipient of nearly 30 years, April 2026"

What the petition establishes

The petition is documentary evidence with specific characteristics:

- 5,674 signatures on a paper petition formally received by the Legislative Assembly of Alberta, in a form that satisfies the Legislature's own requirements for petition recognition. These are not online clicks; they are physical signatures collected by community volunteers in multiple Alberta cities.
- Every signatory has, by signing, publicly affirmed opposition to the transition the Government of Alberta has characterized as having been shaped by the population. Signatories are verifiable. The addresses and names are on record with the Constituency Office that received them.
- The petition was organized and circulated in the months immediately following the Government's stated September 12, 2025 consultation close. If the consultation had produced

the consent the government's rhetorical framing implies, an organized post-consultation campaign against the resulting program would not plausibly have produced this scale of response.

- The petition organizer is himself an AISH recipient. The signature gatherers are community volunteers, many of them also recipients or family members. The population signing the petition is the population the consultation was supposedly about.

The asymmetry argument

The Government of Alberta's consultation claim, if substantiated, would permit the government to publish a list of "Albertans with disabilities who participated in consultation and support the ADAP framework as designed." Such a list, if it existed with recipient-status verification and with numbers exceeding the 5,674 paper signatures on the Learie petition, would substantively rebut the argument this document is making.

As of the date of this document, the Government of Alberta has not published such a list. The government has not produced, in response to municipal motions calling for an ADAP pause, in response to opposition questions in the legislature, or in response to advocacy organization requests, any documented count of AISH recipients who participated in the consultation and who support the program as designed that approaches or exceeds the count of AISH recipients who have signed the petition opposing it.

The asymmetry is the argument. If the consultation produced recipient consent, the government has the evidence to demonstrate it. If the government does not produce that evidence, the consultation did not produce consent — regardless of how many stakeholders, providers, and professional voices contributed to the "thousands" the consultation recorded.

5,674 paper signatures, tabled at the Legislature, verifiable by name and address, opposing the program the government claims reflects what Albertans with disabilities asked for. The government cannot produce an equivalent documented count of Albertans with disabilities affirming the program. The asymmetry is the argument."

LAYER 5 The government bypassed its own standing disability advisory body

The Government of Alberta possesses a standing statutory advisory body on disability matters: the Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities. The Council is established under the Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities Act, RSA 2000, c P-21, which provides the legislative framework for the Council's mandate, membership, and advisory function. The Council has existed, in various forms and under various legislation, for decades. It

is not a new body. It is not a campaign-driven body. It is the provincial government's own permanent institutional mechanism for gathering input from Albertans with disabilities on matters affecting them.

What the statute requires

Section 1 of the Act enumerates the Council's functions, which include (in relevant part):

'(g) advise the Government regarding the alignment between policies and strategies affecting persons with disabilities and the principles of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities; (h) provide input into the development of business plans of Government departments that affect persons with disabilities; (i) advise the Government on reviews and development of policies, programs and initiatives and their implementation with respect to the effect on services to persons with disabilities.' — *Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities Act, RSA 2000, c P-21, s. 1"*

The statutory language is explicit. The Council's function includes advising the Government on the development of policies and programs affecting persons with disabilities. The Council's function includes providing input into the development of business plans of Government departments that affect persons with disabilities. The Council's function includes advising the Government on the alignment of provincial policies with the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities — the instrument Canada ratified on March 11, 2010, and whose Article 4(3) requires states parties to "closely consult with and actively involve persons with disabilities... through their representative organizations" in the development and implementation of legislation and policies affecting them.

What the Council's Indigenous dimension adds

The Council's 2022-2023 Annual Report documents that one of its six subcommittees is specifically focused on "Indigenous people with disabilities and their families." The Council has, as a matter of its own documented operation, the institutional capacity to engage with the Indigenous dimension of disability policy that is central to the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition's impact on disabled Indigenous Albertans. The Indigenous subcommittee exists. The Council's strategic planning cycle explicitly contemplates Indigenous disability perspectives. The mechanism for integrated consultation was in place.

The Council's 2026-2029 Strategic Plan development

The Council develops its strategic plan on a three-year cycle. The 2023-2026 Strategic Plan is, at the time of this document's publication, reaching the end of its cycle. The Council is now

actively developing its 2026-2029 Strategic Plan. As documented by a Facebook post from Autism Calgary on April 18, 2026, the Council has issued a public call for community input on the 2026-2029 plan with a deadline of April 30, 2026.

Autism Calgary's post describes the Council's input request in these terms:

The Premier's Council is responsible for advising the Government on matters relating to the opportunity for full and equal participation of persons with disabilities in all aspects of life in the Province. The Council's advice is informed by listening to Albertans with disabilities, their families, advocacy organizations, service providers, and Council members' own lived experiences with disability. The Council is currently developing its next three-year Strategic Plan (2026–2029). As part of this work, they are seeking input from the community to ensure the priorities reflect the issues and concerns that matter most to the disability community. — Autism Calgary, April 18, 2026, sharing Premier's Council survey link"

A broader structural pattern: the Council's consultation is itself online

This document must acknowledge a complication that goes to the heart of the structural analysis. The Premier's Council's current 2026-2029 Strategic Plan community input request is being conducted through a Google Forms online survey. The Council's 2023-2026 Strategic Plan development survey was also conducted through an online survey and received 381 responses total. The Council's consultation modality is the same modality this document identified in Layer 1 as structurally inaccessible to a substantial share of the AISH caseload.

The implication is not that Layer 5 collapses. The implication is that the problem is larger than Layer 5 alone describes. Alberta's disability consultation infrastructure — including the statutory advisory body whose mandate explicitly covers alignment with the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities — is systemically reliant on consultation methods that exclude the populations Article 4(3) of the Convention names as the specific populations to be consulted. The bypass is real. And the body that was bypassed is itself not yet operating the accessible consultation framework the Convention requires.

The honest reading is this: the Government of Alberta did not route ADAP consultation through a Council that would have produced fully accessible consultation. The Government of Alberta routed ADAP consultation outside a Council that was, and still is, struggling with the same structural accessibility problems the bespoke ADAP process exhibited. The structural gap is therefore province-wide, not government-department-specific. It implicates the standing statutory advisory body as well as the Department of Assisted Living and Social Services. The remedy must be correspondingly broader: both the bespoke process and the Council's own

methods require reform before either can be characterized as having met the consultation standards the Convention and the Council's own statute establish.

The bypass of the Council is a real structural gap in the ADAP consultation process. The Council's own current consultation methods also fall short of the accessibility standards the Convention and the Council's statute require. Both findings are true. Both must be named. Reform must reach both."

The temporal overlap and the structural question

The Premier's Council's 2026-2029 Strategic Plan development cycle overlapped with the ADAP consultation period in significant ways:

- The ADAP Discussion Guide was released in summer 2025.
- ADAP public engagement ran from August 13 to September 12, 2025.
- The Council's 2023-2026 Strategic Plan was in its final year of implementation.
- The Council's institutional capacity and mandate to advise on ADAP existed throughout the ADAP consultation period.
- The Council's 2026-2029 Strategic Plan development, with its current call for community input ending April 30, 2026, is running now — after ADAP legislation has been enacted but before ADAP implementation on July 1, 2026.

The structural question the temporal overlap raises: why did the Government of Alberta not route ADAP consultation through the Council that exists, by statute, to advise on exactly this type of policy development? The Council's mandate explicitly covers "the development of policies, programs and initiatives and their implementation with respect to the effect on services to persons with disabilities." ADAP is a policy, a program, and an initiative whose implementation affects services to persons with disabilities. The Act requires the Council to advise the Government on exactly this. The government chose, instead, to run a separate bespoke consultation process through the Department of Assisted Living and Social Services.

Why this matters

Routing ADAP consultation through the Premier's Council would have produced several structural characteristics the bespoke process did not:

- The Council's consultation processes are required by statute to align with the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities. The bespoke process was not.
- The Council's membership includes persons with disabilities appointed by Order in Council after public vetting. The bespoke process drew from whoever responded to an online survey or attended a telephone town hall.

- The Council's consultation processes include specific subcommittees for particular populations — including Indigenous people with disabilities. The bespoke process had no such structural differentiation.
- The Council's consultation processes, even when conducted through online surveys, are framed as advisory input feeding into a multi-stakeholder analytic process led by disability community members themselves. The bespoke process was framed as government consultation gathering input for government decision-making.
- The Council's own 2022 strategic plan development survey received 381 responses total. If the ADAP bespoke process drew “thousands” while the Council’s formal statutory mechanism drew 381, the difference reflects where the government directed participation effort — away from the standing mechanism, toward the bespoke process the government directly controlled.

The Government of Alberta made a choice. It chose to conduct the most consequential disability policy change in a generation outside the institutional framework its own statute established for exactly this purpose. That choice is itself a documentation gap. A government that relied on its standing advisory body for this consultation would have a defensible structural answer to the concerns raised in Layers 1 through 4. A government that bypassed that body has to defend the bypass itself as part of defending the consultation.

The Premier’s Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities exists. Its statute requires it to advise on the development of disability policy and programs. The government chose to route ADAP consultation outside the Council. The bypass is not a detail. It is a structural choice that the government has to defend in addition to defending the consultation itself.”

What this document asks

This document is not a request for the Government of Alberta to accept the conclusions of advocacy organizations. It is a request that the government substantiate its own consultation claim with the evidence its own administrative systems possess. Specifically:

Of the Government of Alberta

- Publish the breakdown of the “thousands of Albertans” reported as consultation participants, disaggregated by (a) current AISH recipient status, (b) current recipient of other disability benefits, (c) family member or caregiver of a recipient, (d) service provider or advocate, (e) non-recipient Albertan with a disability, (f) other. If the government cannot publish this breakdown, the assertion that “thousands of Albertans with disabilities” shaped the program is not substantiated by the government’s own data.
- Publish the count of AISH recipients who participated in consultation and who affirm the ADAP framework as designed. If the government cannot produce a recipient count that exceeds the

5,674 paper signatures on the Learie petition, the government's consultation claim is not substantiated against the documented counter-evidence.

- Formally document the reason ADAP consultation was conducted outside the Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities framework, given the Council's explicit statutory mandate covering the subject matter.
- Delay the July 1, 2026 ADAP implementation pending consultation that meets the accessibility requirements of the Accessible Canada Act and the consultation requirements of Article 4(3) of the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities.

Of the Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities

- Adopt, for the remainder of the 2026-2029 Strategic Plan community input window and for all subsequent Council consultations, consultation modalities that meet the accessibility requirements of Article 4(3) of the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities. These modalities must include, at minimum: plain-language written materials available in print and electronic formats; telephone-based submission options that do not require attendance at scheduled town halls; facility-based in-person consultation for Albertans residing in group homes, supportive living, and long-term care; translated and accessible formats for cognitive and communication disabilities; and extended submission windows that accommodate the longer response times that many disability conditions require.
- Extend the April 30, 2026 deadline for 2026-2029 Strategic Plan community input to accommodate the accessible modalities above, recognizing that an April 18 survey announcement with an April 30 deadline did not provide sufficient notice for the community to access the online form even through existing channels, and did not permit any deployment of the accessible modalities listed above.
- Document in the Council's 2026-2029 Strategic Plan the structural gap between the government's ADAP consultation process and the Council's statutory framework, and make formal recommendations to the Government regarding future consultation processes affecting disability policy.
- Include in the Council's strategic plan priorities the relationship between the Council's statutory advisory function and bespoke departmental consultation processes that bypass it.
- Report publicly on the Council's assessment of the ADAP transition's alignment with Article 4(3) of the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities.
- Publish, as part of the 2026-2029 Strategic Plan development, a public accounting of the Council's own consultation accessibility and a commitment to reform the methods by which the Council gathers the community input its statute directs it to gather.

Of federal and provincial opposition parties

- Table the specific findings of this document in relevant committees and question periods.
- Request, through formal parliamentary or legislative procedure, the participant breakdown data this document identifies as outstanding.
- Support provincial legislative or administrative action delaying the July 1, 2026 ADAP implementation pending consultation that meets statutory and international requirements.

Of municipal partners

- Incorporate this document's structural analysis into existing municipal motions calling for ADAP pause. The motions are strengthened by explicit reference to the documented consultation gap and to the Premier's Council bypass.
- Request, as part of municipal advocacy to the provincial government, the publication of the participant breakdown data identified above.

Closing

The Government of Alberta's consultation claim is foundational to the ADAP rollout. Every ministerial defence of the program traces back to the assertion that the program reflects what Albertans with disabilities asked for. That assertion does not survive structural examination.

The consultation method excluded the population it was about. The "thousands" were predominantly stakeholders, not recipients. Key provisions — including the removal of independent appeal rights and the revision of employment income exemption figures — were introduced after consultation closed. The petition tabled at the Alberta Legislature constitutes documented empirical rebuttal of the claim that the consultation produced recipient consent. And the government's choice to bypass its own standing statutory advisory body — the Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities — represents an additional structural gap the government must account for. The Council itself, as Layer 5 documents, is operating consultation methods that do not yet meet the accessibility standards its statute and the UN Convention require. The problem is province-wide. The remedy must be correspondingly broad.

The consultation claim cannot be sustained. The program was not shaped by Albertans with disabilities in the way the government's rhetorical framing implies. The July 1, 2026 implementation date should be delayed until consultation that meets statutory and international accessibility requirements has been conducted, including through the standing advisory body the provincial statute establishes for exactly this purpose.

The Alberta disability community is not asking for preferential treatment. It is asking the Government of Alberta to meet the consultation obligations its own statute, the federal Accessible Canada Act, the UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, and the

principle of meaningful democratic participation already require. What the government has conducted is not yet that. What must happen before July 1, 2026 is.

Thousands of Albertans participated, the government says. The documented record establishes that the thousands were predominantly not recipients, that key provisions were added after they could have participated, that 5,674 recipients have formally signed against the outcome, and that the government bypassed its own statutory advisory body in running the process. The government has the data to resolve every question this document raises. Publication of that data is the minimum the consultation claim requires to survive examination."

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Premier's Council on the Status of Persons with Disabilities Act, RSA 2000, c P-21. Statute establishing the Council, its mandate, and its statutory advisory functions. Section 1 enumerates duties including (g) alignment with UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, (h) input into Government department business plans, (i) advice on development of policies, programs and initiatives affecting services to persons with disabilities.

Red Deer Advocate. "Petition calls on government to stop transition from AISH to ADAP." October 31, 2025. Documents petition circulation beyond Edmonton including Red Deer volunteer Terri Grills collecting signatures at Red Deer City Hall and at Junktiques downtown.

United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities. Adopted by UN General Assembly December 13, 2006. Ratified by Canada March 11, 2010. Article 4(3) requires states parties to closely consult with and actively involve persons with disabilities through their representative organizations in the development and implementation of legislation and policies affecting them.

your.alberta.ca/adap. Alberta Online Engagement survey portal for ADAP consultation. Documents 20-25 minute survey duration, August 13 to September 14, 2025 survey window, and consultation topics.

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